

Textual Information Flow



In this module, you will learn how to write coherent and cohesive texts. To do this effectively, you need to ensure that your paragraphs are well structured and that your ideas flow logically from one sentence to the next. When information flows smoothly, it becomes much easier for your reader to follow your thinking.

1. Read the text below, which explains how to ensure your information flows by paying attention to Given and New information.
2. Check your understanding of information flow by doing an activity.
3. Watch the video, which explains how sentences need to be related to the topic sentence.



Readings



Essential: Information Flow

Main point

Never put new information at the beginning of a sentence.

The information at the beginning of the sentence must already be known to the reader.

Previously, you learnt that a clause has a beginning and an ending. The beginning of the clause is **Given** information - information that is known to the reader; the ending is **New**

information - information that the reader has not seen before and which must be attended to (see Given and New Information in the pre-tutorial).

What do you think "information flow" means and how do you do this? Think of three points.

Information flow

1. *Ideas follow each other logically*

2.

3.

4.

Read the following text on information flow to see if your ideas are mentioned.

Information flow

Information Flow in Paragraphs

When you write a paragraph, your sentences must be **linked** so the information flows smoothly.

To do this, start each sentence with **Given information**—something the reader already knows. Don't begin with **New information**.

Two Ways to Organise Information

1. Direct Method

Each sentence starts with the same or similar Given information.

Example:

Paragraphs have one idea. **They** have multiple sentences. **They** have a topic sentence. **Paragraphs** should cohesive and coherent.

NOTE: This method is clear but can feel like a list.

The paragraph has been divided into Given and New information in the table below.



Links have been made from Subjects to the previous subject.



2. Zigzag Method

New information in one sentence becomes the Given in the next.

Example:

*Paragraphs have **one idea**. **This idea** is mentioned in **the topic sentence**. **The topic sentence** is then developed over **many sentences**. **These sentences** should be **coherent and cohesive**. **Coherency and cohesiveness** are achieved by making sure only Given information is at the beginning of a clause.*

This method helps develop ideas.

The paragraph has been divided into Given and New information in the table below.



Links have been made from Subjects to a previous mention of the subject.



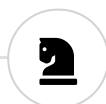
How to Link Sentences

You can link Given and New information using the following strategies.

Linking Strategy		Full Sentence Example	
Repetition	The topic sentence...	This topic sentence...	The topic sentence introduces the main idea of the paragraph. This topic sentence also signals how the argument will develop.
	The plans...	This blueprint...	The plans show the proposed layout for the new building. This blueprint highlights the areas designated for public use.

Antonyms	<i>Happiness...</i>	<i>Sadness...</i>	<i>Happiness is often associated with strong social connections. Sadness, however, may result from social isolation.</i>
Pronouns	<i>The assessments...</i>	<i>They...</i>	<i>The assessments were designed to measure academic readiness. They also help teachers identify areas for improvement.</i>
Part/Whole Relationship	<i>The human body...</i>	<i>The head...</i>	<i>The human body relies on complex systems working together. The head, for instance, houses the brain, which coordinates these systems.</i>
Word Families	<i>Trees...</i>	<i>Shrubs...</i>	<i>Trees provide essential habitats for wildlife. Shrubs also contribute to ecological diversity in similar ways.</i>
Word Forms	<i>A smoke detector fails...</i>	<i>This failure...</i>	<i>A smoke detector fails when its battery is depleted. This failure can lead to increased risk during an emergency.</i>
Conceptual Link	<i>time management at university</i>	<i>Balancing study with part-time work</i>	<i>Many students struggle with time management at university. Balancing study with part-time work can make this challenge even greater.</i>

The important point is: "**Never begin your clause with New information**". Check that you can link the Subject in the Given with something that has previously been mentioned.



Check your understanding

Information flow

To help you make your texts cohesive and coherent in terms of information flow, do the following activity.

Move the parts of sentences up and down to make a coherent and cohesive paragraph. Note: punctuation has been removed in some cases.

because many so-called synonyms are not really synonyms at all



however, to call a person stingy is an insult



while the word *frugal* has much more positive connotation



similarly, a person wants to be slender but not skinny



therefore, you should be careful in choosing words



for example, the words *stingy* and *frugal* both mean "careful with money"



and assertive but not pushy



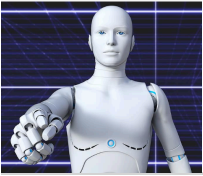
synonyms, words that have the same basic meaning, do not always have the same emotional meaning



 Submit



Videos



Essential: Unity in academic writing

Unity in Paragraphs

Paragraphs have one idea. They have a topic sentence. They have multiple sentences. Paragraphs should be coherent and cohesive, meaning that all the sentences in the paragraph need to be connected to the topic sentence.

Watch the video. The speaker asks you to complete an activity during the video. When instructed, pause the video and do the activity and then check your answers as the speaker explains the answers.

Unity in English academic writing [🔗 \(https://www.bilibili.com/video/BV14N4y1w7w3/?spm_id_from=333.337.search-card.all.click\)](https://www.bilibili.com/video/BV14N4y1w7w3/?spm_id_from=333.337.search-card.all.click)



Questions & Answers

Information flow

If you have any questions, or would like to discuss answers, please post in the

Textual Module: Q&A Discussion Forum
(https://canvas.utscollge.edu.au/courses/7983/discussion_topics/198365)